

Psych UG Programs Committee Meeting Agenda Friday Oct 10th, 2025, 2-3pm

Members: Arlen, Nikki, Rob, Kristina, & Lindsay

Rotating note taking: ~~August 19 (Arlen), Sept 2 (Nikki), Sept 16 (Rob), Oct 3 (Kristina),~~
Oct 10 (Arlen), Oct 21 (Lindsay), Nov 4 (Arlen), Nov 18 (Nikki), Dec 1 (Rob), Dec 16 (Kristina)

[Shared OneDrive](#)

1. Program Evaluations

- Reports for PSYC and BEHW due by Wednesday, **Oct 15th**
- A transcript of this meeting will be generated by MS Teams and uploaded with the Program Evaluation reports.
- We have 1 remaining student in Applied Analytics who I think is graduating this year (program has been sunset/eliminated)

BS Psych Science

- Current enrollment: 52 (6 are Dual Majors with Bio or Bio chem)
 - - confirm # of dual degrees who may not be counted in our reports (or advisor assignment). Katie Spink, and Lewis College professional advisors, Jen and Paige
- Current Learning Objectives (LOs) for PSYC
 - i. **LO1** -- Students will appropriately apply basic research methods in psychology, including research design, data analysis, and interpretation.
 - ii. **LO2** -- Students will be able to describe key concepts, principles, and applications of psychology
 - iii. **LO3** -- Students will demonstrate effective communication to scientific and professional audiences

Consider papers written for Adult and Child Development courses (LO2 and LO3). The PSY204 poster presentation could also be used for LO3. Rob confirmed that PSY204 posters have been done recently and they also do in-class oral presentations. Rob's PSY310 courses includes 3-4 "thought papers" that could also fit for LO2. PSY301 IO has a group project with a presentation, group presentation on article they've read. PSY301 homework applying concepts to yourself. For LO2, an exam could work if there's essay questions with "describing" key concepts, principles. Rob says PSY203 has an exam with essay questions like this.

IO Masters program has artifacts that allow for assessing change on metrics over time.

- Rob assembled descriptive stats for PSY204 SP25 (LO1).

- i. For PSYC (n=21) for BEHW (n=1)
- Arlen is working on data from PSY312 (LO2 and LO3).
 - i. For PSYC (n=15 out of 29), for BEHW (n=0 out of 29)
- How often should we plan to evaluate each of these LOs? We've been doing it every year, but sample sizes have been too small to meaningfully assess change. Could be anywhere from every year to every five years for each.

Masters in IO analyzes data every 3 years; PhD in IO every 4 years.

For full set of table and text interpreting patterns.

Every year, just reporting the # of students in the program and # of students who fell into each category of competency level.

Discussed reducing frequency from every year to every 3 years for full analysis and interpretation of all 3 LOs for Psych Science Degree.

BS BEHW

- Current enrollment: 6
- Current LOs for BEHW
 - i. L1 Students will appropriately apply basic research methods in psychology, including research design, data analysis, and interpretation.
 - ii. L2 Students will be able to describe key concepts, principles, and applications of psychology
 - iii. L3 Students will demonstrate effective communication to scientific and professional audiences
- Arlen paused sunsetting BEHW degree because of the emphasis on “health professions” as a potential unifying theme of the January 2025 Lewis College Retreat. But it's evident we have very few majors (6) and should revisit this decision today. If we decide to continue it we would need support from Social Sciences and Food Sciences (each “owns” a specialization track in the BEHW degree program that has never been well developed).

2. Continuous Program Improvements

- Review CPI ideas in draft report for PSYC
- The official HLC accreditation program evaluations require a “Continuous Improvement Plan,” but we can also discuss additional plans for program improvement internally.
- Do we want to implement some recommendations from the APA workshop on Market Ready Majors?
 - i. Add job skill text to several of our regularly offered courses?

- ii. Develop a workshop or career readiness course for 4th years similar to ITP, but for the Fall/Spring of students' final year before graduation? e.g., complete the job search activity described below.
- Several of our upper-level courses are challenging to cover and consistently require adjunct instructors. Should any of these be paused or eliminated?
 - i. Combine PSY435 and PSY436 into Human Development?
 - ii. Eliminate PSY423 Learning Theory?

PSYC 414	Neural and Biological Bases of Behavior
PSYC 423	Learning Theory
PSYC 426	Cognitive Science
PSYC 435	Child Development
PSYC 436	Adult Development

- Should the “Pick 4” from a small list requirement (12 credits) be eliminated and combined with the more general Psych Elective requirement (15 credits)? i.e., make the Psych Elective requirement (27 credits; 9 courses)? Note, this is what the BEHW degree looks like already ([30 credits of upper level BEHW, no special subset](#)).
- Should any new courses be prioritized for development and regularly offered? e.g.,
 - i. Add another required methods course or require both PSY320 and 409 (instead of pick 1)?
 - ii. Add a required Psych & Emerging Technology or Psych & AI courses
 - iii. Add an internship/coop program or course for UGs (see data from marketing/admissions below indicating this is a top priority of prospective students)? Could Kristina get compensation from the Center for Research and Service or Career Services to manage internship opportunities for both Masters in I/O and UG?

Data presented by Mallik at Friday Oct 10th 2025 UFC meeting:

Internships and applied learning were rated the most important experiences for prospective students

2025 ASR: Analytic Report
IIT
Curriculum Interests & Learning Priorities

Which of the following experiences are most important to your learning goals? Select up to three.

Non-Matrices | Matrics | Δ (M-NM)

